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一、中英文主旨

中文主旨

本文探讨了全球正在经历的前所未有的并购浪潮，分析了其产生的原因、带来的影响以及引发的担忧，指出并购浪潮背后的动力与全球化进程的动力一致，总体上对消费者有利，但同时也强调必须对这一运动进行密切监管。

英文主旨

This article discusses the unprecedented wave of mergers and acquisitions sweeping the globe, analyzes its causes, impacts and concerns, points out that the forces behind the M&A wave are the same as those driving globalization, which is generally beneficial to consumers, but also emphasizes that close supervision over this movement is necessary.

二、逐句翻译与解析

第一段

1. **原文**: The world is going through the biggest wave of mergers and acquisitions ever witnessed.

翻译: 世界正在经历一场有史以来规模最大的并购浪潮。

常考单词/短语:

- go through 经历; 通过
- merger n. (公司等的) 合并, 并购
- acquisition n. 收购; 获得
- witness v. 见证; 目击 n. 证人; 目击者

2. **原文**: The process sweeps from hyperactive America to Europe and reaches the emerging countries with unsurpassed might.

翻译: 这一浪潮从极度活跃的美国席卷到欧洲, 并以无可匹敌的力量延伸至新兴国家。

常考单词/短语:

- sweep v. 席卷; 横扫; 打扫
- hyperactive adj. 极度活跃的; 多动的
- emerging countries 新兴国家
- unsurpassed adj. 无可匹敌的; 无与伦比的
- might n. 力量; 威力

3. **原文**: Many in these countries are looking at this process and worrying: "Won't the wave of business concentration turn into an uncontrollable anti-competitive force?"

翻译: 这些国家的许多人看着这一进程, 忧心忡忡: “这种商业集中的浪潮会不会变成一股无法控制的反竞争力量?”

常考单词/短语:

- concentration n. 集中; 专注; 浓度
- turn into 变成
- uncontrollable adj. 无法控制的
- anti-competitive adj. 反竞争的
- force n. 力量; 势力; 武力

本段概括: 第一段指出全球正经历前所未有的并购浪潮, 其范围遍及欧美及新兴国家, 并引发了人们对商业集中可能导致反竞争力量的担忧。

第二段

1. **原文:** There's no question that the big are getting bigger and more powerful.

翻译: 毫无疑问, 大企业正在变得更大、更强。

常考单词/短语:

- There's no question that 毫无疑问
- powerful adj. 强大的; 有力的

2. **原文:** Multinational corporations accounted for less than 20% of international trade in 1982.

翻译: 1982年, 跨国公司在国际贸易中所占的份额还不到20%。

常考单词/短语:

- multinational corporation 跨国公司
- account for (比例) 占; 解释; 说明
- international trade 国际贸易

3. **原文:** Today the figure is more than 25% and growing rapidly.

翻译: 如今这一数字已超过25%, 并且还在迅速增长。

常考单词/短语:

- figure n. 数字; 人物; 图形
- rapidly adv. 迅速地; 快速地

4. **原文:** International affiliates account for a fast-growing segment of production in economies that open up and welcome foreign investment.

翻译: 在那些对外开放并欢迎外资的经济体中, 国际分公司在生产中所占的份额正在快速增长。

常考单词/短语:

- affiliate n. 分公司; 附属机构 v. 使附属
- segment n. 部分; 段; 节
- economy n. 经济体; 经济
- open up 开放; 打开
- foreign investment 外国投资

长难句分析: 这是一个复合句, 主句是"International affiliates account for a fast-growing segment of production in economies", 后面的"that open up and welcome foreign investment"是定语从句, 修饰先行词"economies", 说明这些经济体的特点。

5. **原文:** In Argentina, for instance, after the reforms of the early 1990s, multinationals went from 43% to almost 70% of the industrial production of the 200 largest firms.

翻译: 例如在阿根廷, 在20世纪90年代初的改革之后, 跨国公司在200家最大企业的工业生产中所占的比重从43%上升到了近70%。

常考单词/短语:

- for instance 例如
- reform n./v. 改革; 改良
- industrial production 工业生产

6. **原文:** This phenomenon has created serious concerns over the role of smaller economic firms, of national businessmen and over the ultimate stability of the world economy.

翻译: 这一现象引发了人们对小型企业、民族企业家的作用以及世界经济最终稳定性的严重担忧。

常考单词/短语:

- phenomenon n. 现象 (复数: phenomena)
- create concerns over 引发对.....的担忧
- national businessman 民族企业家
- ultimate adj. 最终的; 根本的
- stability n. 稳定性

长难句分析: 这是一个简单句, 但宾语部分较长。主语是"This phenomenon", 谓语是"has created", 宾语是"serious concerns", 后面有两个并列的介词短语"over the role of smaller economic firms, of national businessmen and over the ultimate stability of the world economy".

national businessmen"和"over the ultimate stability of the world economy"作定语，修饰"concerns"，说明担忧的具体内容。

本段概括：第二段通过数据和实例说明大企业规模和实力不断壮大的趋势，并指出这一现象引发了人们对小型企业、民族企业家以及世界经济稳定性的担忧。

第三段

1. **原文：** I believe that the most important forces behind the massive M&A wave are the same that underlie the globalization process: falling transportation and communication costs, lower trade and investment barriers and enlarged markets that require enlarged operations capable of meeting customers' demands.

翻译：我认为，推动这场大规模并购浪潮的最重要力量，与推动全球化进程的力量是相同的：运输和通讯成本的下降、贸易和投资壁垒的降低，以及市场规模的扩大——这要求企业扩大经营规模以满足消费者的需求。

常考单词/短语：

- massive adj. 大规模的；巨大的
- M&A (mergers and acquisitions) 并购
- underlie v. 构成.....的基础；作为.....的原因
- globalization n. 全球化
- transportation n. 运输
- communication n. 通讯；交流
- barrier n. 壁垒；障碍
- enlarge v. 扩大；增大
- operation n. 经营；运作；手术
- capable of 能够
- meet customers' demands 满足消费者需求

长难句分析：这是一个复杂的复合句。主句是"I believe that..."，其中"that"引导宾语从句。宾语从句的主干是"the most important forces... are the same"，后面的"that underlie the globalization process"是定语从句，修饰"the same (forces)"。冒号后面的三个并列名词短语"falling transportation and communication costs, lower trade and investment barriers and enlarged markets"是对前面"the most important forces"的具体解释说明。其中"that require enlarged operations capable of meeting customers' demands"是定语从句，修饰"enlarged markets"，而"capable of meeting customers' demands"是形容词短语作后置定语，修饰"enlarged operations"。

2. **原文：** All these are beneficial, not detrimental, to consumers.

翻译：所有这些对消费者来说都是有益的，而不是有害的。

常考单词/短语：

- beneficial adj. 有益的；有利的
- detrimental adj. 有害的；不利的

3. **原文：** As productivity grows, the world's wealth increases.

翻译：随着生产力的提高，世界财富也在增加。

常考单词/短语：

- productivity n. 生产力；生产率
- wealth n. 财富；财产

本段概括：第三段指出并购浪潮背后的动力与全球化进程的动力一致，这些因素对消费者有益，并且会促进世界财富的增长。

第四段

1. **原文:** Examples of benefits or costs of the current concentration wave are scanty.

翻译: 目前关于这股集中浪潮带来的益处或代价的实例还很少。

常考单词/短语:

- current adj. 当前的; 现在的
- scanty adj. 不足的; 稀少的

2. **原文:** Yet it is hard to imagine that the merger of a few oil firms today could re-create the same threats to competition that were feared nearly a century ago in the U.S., when the Standard Oil trust was broken up.

翻译: 然而, 很难想象如今几家石油公司的合并会重现近一个世纪前美国所担忧的那种对竞争的威胁, 当时标准石油托拉斯被拆分了。

常考单词/短语:

- re-create v. 重现; 再创造
- threat n. 威胁; 恐吓
- competition n. 竞争
- trust n. 托拉斯 (垄断组织形式)
- break up 拆分; 解散; 分手

长难句分析: 这是一个复合句。主句是"it is hard to imagine that...", 其中"it"是形式主语, 真正的主语是后面的不定式短语"to imagine that..."。"that"引导宾语从句, 宾语从句的主干是"the merger... could re-create the same threats to competition"。后面的"that were feared nearly a century ago in the U.S."是定语从句, 修饰"the same threats"。"when the Standard Oil trust was broken up"是时间状语从句, 修饰"nearly a century ago"。

3. **原文:** The mergers of telecom companies, such as WorldCom, hardly seem to bring higher prices for consumers or a reduction in the pace of technical progress.

翻译: 像世通公司这样的电信公司的合并, 似乎并没有给消费者带来更高的价格, 也没有减缓技术进步的步伐。

常考单词/短语:

- telecom n. 电信 (telecommunication的缩写)
- hardly adv. 几乎不; 简直不
- reduction n. 减少; 降低
- pace n. 步伐; 速度
- technical progress 技术进步

4. **原文:** On the contrary, the price of communications is coming down fast.

翻译: 相反, 通讯价格正在迅速下降。

常考单词/短语:

- on the contrary 相反
- come down 下降; 降低

5. **原文:** In cars, too, concentration is increasing-witness Daimler and Chrysler, Renault and Nissan-but it does not appear that consumers are being hurt.

翻译: 汽车行业也出现了集中化趋势——看看戴姆勒与克莱斯勒、雷诺与日产的合并就知道了——但消费者似乎并没有受到损害。

常考单词/短语:

- witness v. 见证; 目睹; 这里表示“看看.....就知道了”
- appear v. 似乎; 显得; 出现

长难句分析: 这是一个并列复合句。破折号中间的"witness Daimler and Chrysler, Renault and Nissan"是插入语, 用来举例说明汽车行业的集中化趋势。主句是"concentration is increasing"和"but it does not appear that consumers are being hurt", 其中"it"是形式主语, 真正的主语是后面的"that consumers are being hurt"从句。

本段概括：第四段通过石油、电信和汽车行业的例子说明，当前的并购浪潮并没有像过去那样对竞争构成严重威胁，反而在很多情况下让消费者受益。

第五段

1. **原文：** Yet the fact remains that the merger movement must be watched.

翻译：然而事实仍然是，我们必须密切关注这场并购运动。

常考单词/短语：

- remain v. 仍然是；保持；剩余
- watch v. 关注；监视；观看

2. **原文：** A few weeks ago, Alan Greenspan warned against the megamergers in the banking industry.

翻译：几周前，艾伦·格林斯潘就曾警告过银行业的巨型合并。

常考单词/短语：

- warn against 警告；告诫不要
- megamerger n. 巨型合并；大规模合并
- banking industry 银行业

3. **原文：** Who is going to supervise, regulate and operate as lender of last resort with the gigantic banks that are being created?

翻译：对于正在形成的这些巨型银行，谁来负责监督、规范并充当最后贷款人的角色呢？

常考单词/短语：

- supervise v. 监督；管理
- regulate v. 规范；调节；管理
- lender of last resort 最后贷款人
- gigantic adj. 巨大的；庞大的

4. **原文：** Won't multinationals shift production from one place to another when a nation gets too strict about infringements to fair competition?

翻译：当一个国家对违反公平竞争的行为监管过于严格时，跨国公司难道不会把生产从一个地方转移到另一个地方吗？

常考单词/短语：

- shift v. 转移；改变；换挡
- strict about 对.....严格
- infringement n. 违反；侵犯
- fair competition 公平竞争

5. **原文：** And should one country take upon itself the role of "defending competition" on issues that affect many other nations, as in the U.S. vs. Microsoft case?

翻译：而且，在那些影响到许多其他国家的问题上，比如美国诉微软案，是否应该由一个国家独自承担“捍卫竞争”的角色呢？

常考单词/短语：

- take upon oneself 承担；擅自
- defend v. 捍卫；保卫；辩护
- issue n. 问题；议题
- affect v. 影响；使改变
- case n. 案例；情况；案件

本段概括：第五段指出尽管并购浪潮总体有利，但仍需对其进行密切监管，并提出了一系列关于监管主体和监管范围的问题。

三、完整原文与完整翻译

完整原文

The world is going through the biggest wave of mergers and acquisitions ever witnessed. The process sweeps from hyperactive America to Europe and reaches the emerging countries with unsurpassed might. Many in these countries are looking at this process and worrying: "Won't the wave of business concentration turn into an uncontrollable anti-competitive force?"

There's no question that the big are getting bigger and more powerful. Multinational corporations accounted for less than 20% of international trade in 1982. Today the figure is more than 25% and growing rapidly. International affiliates account for a fast-growing segment of production in economies that open up and welcome foreign investment. In Argentina, for instance, after the reforms of the early 1990s, multinationals went from 43% to almost 70% of the industrial production of the 200 largest firms. This phenomenon has created serious concerns over the role of smaller economic firms, of national businessmen and over the ultimate stability of the world economy.

I believe that the most important forces behind the massive M&A wave are the same that underlie the globalization process: falling transportation and communication costs, lower trade and investment barriers and enlarged markets that require enlarged operations capable of meeting customers' demands. All these are beneficial, not detrimental, to consumers. As productivity grows, the world's wealth increases.

Examples of benefits or costs of the current concentration wave are scanty. Yet it is hard to imagine that the merger of a few oil firms today could re-create the same threats to competition that were feared nearly a century ago in the U.S., when the Standard Oil trust was broken up. The mergers of telecom companies, such as WorldCom, hardly seem to bring higher prices for consumers or a reduction in the pace of technical progress. On the contrary, the price of communications is coming down fast. In cars, too, concentration is increasing—witness Daimler and Chrysler, Renault and Nissan—but it does not appear that consumers are being hurt.

Yet the fact remains that the merger movement must be watched. A few weeks ago, Alan Greenspan warned against the megamergers in the banking industry. Who is going to supervise, regulate and operate as lender of last resort with the gigantic banks that are being created? Won't multinationals shift production from one place to another when a nation gets too strict about infringements to fair competition? And should one country take upon itself the role of "defending competition" on issues that affect many other nations, as in the U.S. vs. Microsoft case?

完整翻译

世界正在经历一场有史以来规模最大的并购浪潮。这一浪潮从极度活跃的美国席卷到欧洲，并以无可匹敌的力量延伸至新兴国家。这些国家的许多人看着这一进程，忧心忡忡：“这种商业集中的浪潮会不会变成一股无法控制的反竞争力量？”

毫无疑问，大企业正在变得更大、更强。1982年，跨国公司在国际贸易中所占的份额还不到20%。如今这一数字已超过25%，并且还在迅速增长。在那些对外开放并欢迎外资的经济体中，国际分公司在生产中所占的份额正在快速增长。例如在阿根廷，在20世纪90年代初的改革之后，跨国公司在200家最大企业的工业生产中所占的比重从43%上升到了近70%。这一现象引发了人们对小型企业、民族企业家的作用以及世界经济最终稳定性的严重担忧。

我认为，推动这场大规模并购浪潮的最重要力量，与推动全球化进程的力量是相同的：运输和通讯成本的下降、贸易和投资壁垒的降低，以及市场规模的扩大——这要求企业扩大经营规模以满足消费者的需求。所有这些对消费者来说都是有益的，而不是有害的。随着生产力的提高，世界财富也在增加。

目前关于这股集中浪潮带来的益处或代价的实例还很少。然而，很难想象如今几家石油公司的合并会重现近一个世纪前美国所担忧的那种对竞争的威胁，当时标准石油托拉斯被拆分了。像世通公司这样的电信公司的合并，似乎并没有给消费者带来更高的价格，也没有减缓技术进步的步伐。相反，通讯价格正在迅速下降。汽车行业也出现了集中化趋势——看看戴姆勒与克莱斯勒、雷诺与日产的合并就知道了——但消费者似乎并没有受到损害。

然而事实仍然是，我们必须密切关注这场并购运动。几周前，艾伦·格林斯潘就曾警告过银行业的巨型合并。对于正在形成的这些巨型银行，谁来负责监督、规范并充当最后贷款人的角色呢？当一个国家对违反公平竞争的行为监管过于严格时，跨国公司难道不会把生产从一个地方转移到另一个地方吗？而且，在那些影响到许多其他国家的问题上，比如美国诉微软案，是否应该由一个国家独自承担“捍卫竞争”的角色呢？